



Entrepreneurial Leadership and Strategy

Handbook & Student Guide

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About InfoEdge Centre for Entrepreneurship

The InfoEdge Centre for Entrepreneurship at Ashoka University is known for blending Liberal Arts and Sciences with Entrepreneurship. The Centre offers a unique interdisciplinary approach to learning and creating positive social impact. The



Department offers an Interdisciplinary major with Computer Science, a Minor and a Concentration in Entrepreneurial Leadership and Strategy.

To achieve the goal of driving meaningful change, the Centre provides a range of academic interventions, as well as incubation and acceleration programs, while also offering access to valuable resources, networks, and mentorship opportunities. Our ultimate vision is to Inspire, Inculcate, and Incubate game-changing ideas for India and the world, while also encouraging critical inquiry into the **'Why, What, and How'** of Entrepreneurship.

Visit our website to learn more about us: [Centre for Entrepreneurship](#)

Faculty Members

Some of our Professors are mentioned below:

- Priyank Narayan - Director (HoD), Centre For Entrepreneurship
- Mukesh Sud - Visiting Faculty, IIM Ahmedabad
- Nupur Bang - Associate Director, Thomas Schmidheiny Centre for Family Enterprise, ISB
- Ajay Bahl - Founder and Managing Partner, AZB & Partners
- Vineet Gupta - Founder and Trustee, Ashoka University, Plaksha University, Jamboree
- Akhil Dhawan - Managing Director, Locus Investment Group
- Sanjay Kukreja - Managing Partner, Chrys Capital
- Jaspreet Bindra - Founder, Tech Whisperer Ltd.
- Srikant Shastri - President, TiE Delhi-NCR
- Aditya Ghosh - Co-Founder, Akasa Air
- Pramod Bhasin - Ex-President and CEO, Genpact
- Sunil Handa - Visiting Faculty, IIM Ahmedabad
- Rashmi Bansal - Visiting Faculty, IIM Ahmedabad
- Deepali Singh - Founder and CEO, The WallstreetWiz
- Divya Krishnan - Ex-Chief Investment Officer, SBI Mutual Fund
- Jayakumar (Jakes) - Managing Director and Group CEO, Prime Securities
- Shridhar Sethuram - Partner & MD, Suyash Advisors
- Tushar Jaruhar - Founder, EdLightened
- Sushil Jhangiani - Visiting Faculty, IIM Ahmedabad
- Vani Dandia - Ex-Marketing Director, PepsiCo
- Shantanu Bhanja - Ex-Chief Executive Officer, Pidilite Industries Limited

- Nitin Chaudhary - Chief Business Officer, pinBox Solutions
- Kartik Desai - Founder & CEO, Desai & Associate
- Rohit Anand - Serial Entrepreneur & Co-Founder, 1digitalstack
- Piyush Sharma - Leadership Evangelist @ IIM A, Global CEO
- Asha Kaul - Professor, IIM Ahmedabad
- Rahul Bhasin - Managing Partner, Baring Private Equity Partners India
- Yash Gupta - Managing Partner, YGR
- Navyug Mohnot - CEO, QAI; Founder, QGLUE Strategic Design and Innovation
- Ankur Sarin - Faculty, IIM Ahmedabad
- DVR Seshadri - Faculty, ISB
- Pavan Ahluwalia - Founder & Managing Director, Laburnum Capital
- Piyush Tewari - Founder & CEO, SaveLIFE Foundation
- Promila Agarwal - Professor, IIM Ahmedabad
- Seema Bansal - Partner and Director, Boston Consulting Group (BCG)
- Nikhil Sud - Director of Strategic Initiatives, Ashoka University

Offerings by the Entrepreneurship Department

The Department of Entrepreneurship allows students to explore the following **three options**:

1. Minor in Entrepreneurial Leadership And Strategy

All undergraduate cohorts must complete **24 credits** in Entrepreneurial Leadership and Strategy to obtain a minor degree. A student can opt for any combination of 4 and 2-credit courses to meet the credit requirements. Entrepreneurial Leadership And Strategy is the **largest and most popular Minor** at Ashoka University.

2. Concentration in Entrepreneurial Leadership And Strategy

All undergraduate cohorts must complete **16 credits** in Entrepreneurial Leadership and Strategy to obtain a concentration in the discipline. A student can opt for **any combination** of 4 and 2-credit courses to meet the credit requirements.

3. Interdisciplinary Major in Computer Science and Entrepreneurship

To obtain an Interdisciplinary major in Computer Science and Entrepreneurship, in addition to a pure major in Computer Science, students must complete at least **16 credits** in Entrepreneurial Leadership and Strategy.

Prerequisites for Courses

The Department has set **no prerequisites** for any courses. There is no level-wise sequence of courses you will have to take and hence are free to take courses in any order. However, it is recommended that students take the basic courses first before moving on to the advanced courses.

Other Credit Options

1. Independent Study Module (4 credits)

ISM is a course option that allows students to collaborate closely with a faculty member. These courses can be worth 4 or 2 credits and offer students the chance to engage in research, in ongoing faculty projects or on a topic of their interest. To begin an ISM, students can email a faculty before the semester starts, expressing their interest in undertaking an ISM under their guidance. The project or paper should be discussed with the faculty member and Dr. Priyank- Director/Head of the Department. It is necessary to obtain faculty approval before registering for the ISM course.

2. Teaching Assistance (TA-ship)

As a teaching assistant (TA), your responsibilities may vary depending on the course. These typically include grading quizzes, facilitating discussion sessions, conducting doubt-clearing office hours, and assisting with various logistical aspects of the classes. TAships are generally available to third-year students and ASP students. Though having prior experience in the course can certainly be beneficial, it is not necessarily required to take the specific course before to be a TA. The Taship will yield the same credits as the course, i.e. a 4-credit course will give 4 credits and a

2-credit course will yield 2 credits. These credits can be used to complete Minor/Concentration requirements.

3. Study Abroad

Note that, like any other program at Ashoka, the Study Abroad Programs are subject to changes. Kindly refer to the GESP website for the latest information. Additionally, contact the **department HOD** for further clarification regarding **credit transfers**.

Every summer and semester, international universities offer undergraduate courses in different subjects and fields. These courses can be transferred (subject to faculty approval) to the total credits taken as Ashoka. The **Office of Global Education and Strategic Programmes (GESP)** is available to students for assistance and counselling in the application process.

Ashoka is currently partnered with Wellesley College, UC Berkeley, University of Pennsylvania, Yale University, King's College London, University of Michigan, Penn Engineering, Sciences Po, and Trinity College Dublin and many more.

For any enquiries on the process of applying for a summer/semester abroad, kindly email studyabroad@ashoka.edu.in.

A few courses/ international programs that students of the department have previously engaged with:

- Marketing UGBA 106 - *UC Berkley, USA*
- Entrepreneurship: The Startup Studio - *HEC Paris, France*
- International Business - *King's College London, UK*
- Entrepreneurial Solutions to Intractable Social & Economic Problems-
Harvard University, USA
- Advanced Corporate Finance - *London School of Economics, UK*

- Management and Economics of Innovation - *London School of Economics, UK*
- *Israel Tel-Aviv Immersion Programme*
- *South Africa Entrepreneurship Immersion Programme*

and many more...

4. Entrepreneurship Capstone

All students who intend to graduate with a Minor in Entrepreneurial Leadership and Strategy are eligible to apply for the Entrepreneurship Capstone (4 credits). These projects are floated by industry practitioners and entrepreneurial organizations with the aim of giving students practical experience and exposure to skills that may be relevant to early career opportunities. The students learn to work in teams in a thriving environment and increase their network in the entrepreneurship and corporate world. The student should discuss the project and deliverables with the Head of Department, Centre for Entrepreneurship.

5. Venture Immersion Project

The Venture Immersion Project is for students in their third or fourth year. In this 4 program, students are given the opportunity to work with existing startups across the globe and increase their skill set, broaden their network and get industry exposure.

Overview

Course	Faculty	Credit	Old Name/Code
ENT-2044 Fundamentals of Quantitative Problem Solving with Excel	Ashish Mathur	2	ENT-2038-1 Problem Solving using Microsoft Excel
ENT-2027 Impact Investing, ESG and Climate	Kartik Desai	4	
ENT-2042 Technology and Product Management	Nikhil Sud	4	ENT-1012 Essentials of Technology Product Management
ENT-2040 Strategies for Revenue Leadership	Gaurav Rastogi	2	
ENT-1011 Fundamentals of Marketing	Prakash Dharmarajan	4	
ENT-3016 Financial Analytics using Artificial Intelligence	Tushar Jaruhar	4	ENT-3012-1 Financial Analytics and Artificial Intelligence

ENT-2045 Business Applications of Data Science	Tushar Jaruhar	4	ENT-2017-1 Artificial Intelligence and Data Analytics
ENT-2034 Demystifying Investments: Private Equity and Venture Capital	Sridhar Sethuram	4	
ENT-2011 Business Analysis and Strategy	Akhil Dhawan, Sanjay Kukreja, Pavan A.	4	
ENT-2022 Life Design Lab	Navyug Mohnot	2	
ENT-3011 Strategies for Market Access	Shantanu Bhanja	4	
ENT-1004 Creativity and Design Thinking	Priyank Narayan	4	
ENT-2032/ POL-2120 Technology Law and Policy: A New Frontier for Business and Society	Nikhil Sud	4	
ENT-2034 Demystifying Investments: Private Equity and Venture Capital	Sridhar Sethuram	4	

ENT-2039 Law and Lawyerly Thinking: An Introduction for Entrepreneurs and Beyond	Nikhil Sud	4	
ENT-1016 Jugaad and the Tech Enterprise	Jaideep Prabhu, Mukesh Sud, Priyank	2	
ENT-4012 Venture Design Lab	Srikant Shastri	4	ENT-4011 SIL: Startup Readiness and Grand Challenge
ENT-1019 Digital Ecosystem of India	Arvind Gupta	2	ENT-1013 Data and the Digital Economy
ENT-1014 Quantitative Methods for Entrepreneurs	Rahul Mehta	2	
ENT 2002 Social Entrepreneurship & Impact	Advaita R.	4	
ENT-1008 Accounting and Financial Statements	Deepali Singh	4	
ENT-2028-1 Integrated Digital Marketing Strategy	Shradha Agarwal	2	
ENT-3007 Fundamentals of Investing	Deepali Singh, Rahul Bhasin	4	

ENT-3014/ PSY-3164 Branding and Consumer Behaviour (Advanced)	Vani Dandia	4	
ENT-2019/ PSY-3163 Branding and Consumer Behaviour	Vani Dandia	4	
ENT-2012-1 Real Estate and Investments	Yash Gupta	2	

Courses for Spring 2025

ENT 1004-1: Creativity and Design Thinking - Dr. Priyank Narayan

“Is AI really taking jobs away?” is a question that we often get asked by students. While everyone has their own way of answering this question, the answer often revolves around the word ‘creativity’. The World Economic Forum’s Future of Jobs report year after year ranks creativity as the most sought-after skill in the job market. This course teaches you exactly that - creative problem-solving. The ability to create and innovate isn’t just a skill, it’s a mindset. This course will guide you through the process of enhancing your creative abilities, helping you recognize and nurture your innate potential. With hands-on activities and case studies, you’ll learn to generate original ideas and turn them into actionable solutions. Every good solution begins with a well-defined problem. Defining problems and being creative about solving problems has come to be known as design thinking.

Design thinking is a human-centred approach to innovation that’s used by some of the world’s leading companies like Apple, Google, and Airbnb. Through this course, you’ll learn how to empathize with users, define problems clearly, ideate, prototype, and test solutions. It’s more than just theory—you’ll walk away with practical skills that can be applied across industries. You will learn design thinking through live-action projects. In this project, you will provide consulting services to startups, and use design thinking methodology to solve their problem statements. This is a 13-week course comprising 39 classroom hours and approximately 20 hours of project work, group assignments and book readings. The Mid Term Project and the End Term Project will be team-based submissions.

ENT-1008 - Accounting and Financial Statements - Deepali Singh

The Accounting and Financial Statements course offers a comprehensive foundation in accounting principles and financial statement analysis, essential for students and

professionals in finance, business, and management. This course covers a wide range of topics, including the structure and content of key financial statements—income statements, balance sheets, and cash flow statements. Participants will delve into the critical interactions between these statements, gaining insights into how they reflect a company's financial health. The course content is designed to provide practical knowledge applicable in various industries, including finance, investment banking, corporate finance, and entrepreneurship. Students will learn to analyze real-world financial data from different companies, enhancing their ability to interpret and evaluate financial statements in professional settings. Key skills developed throughout the course include proficiency in financial analysis, an understanding of accrual accounting, and the ability to create and interpret financial models using Excel. These skills are vital for roles in financial analysis, accounting, and management, where decision-making is heavily reliant on accurate financial data interpretation.

Participants will engage with a variety of topics that lay the groundwork for effective financial decision-making. They will learn about revenue recognition, fixed and variable costs, and key financial metrics such as EBITDA and net income. The course also covers working capital management, including inventories, receivables, and payables, providing students with tools to assess a company's operational efficiency and cash flow cycles. Additionally, the course explores asset management, debt and equity structures, and the intricacies of cash flow statement construction, ensuring a holistic understanding of corporate financial dynamics.

As students progress through the course, they will also explore the accounting for investments, including the treatment of equity investments and their impact on consolidated financial statements. This knowledge is crucial for professionals involved in mergers and acquisitions, investment analysis, and corporate finance. By the end of the course,

participants will be equipped with a robust toolkit of analytical and modelling skills, enabling them to contribute effectively to their organizations and make informed financial decisions.

ENT-1011-1- Fundamentals of Marketing - Prakash Dharmarajan

This course is designed to teach you the fundamentals of marketing keeping in mind an entrepreneurial context. The course assumes no knowledge of marketing, and moves from the fundamentals of defining and capturing value and understanding consumers to key marketing concepts such as segmentation, targeting and positioning, and then culminates in the in-market execution of positioning using a synergistic mix of product development, pricing management, communication and in-market execution. The course also looks at brands, brand strategy and brand equity and their impact on consumer value and brand strength. We will look at marketing theory but with a strong application bias. We will pick on our experiences as customers and how we are impacted by marketing as we seek to understand how to market products and services. You will be well served by relying on your experiences as consumers, and for keeping your eyes open and observing other customers as a marketer.

ENT 1014 -1 - Quantitative Methods for Entrepreneurs - Rahul Mehta (2 credits)

Quantitative Methods for Entrepreneurs looks to give students a framework to evaluate companies/industries using quantitative methods. In every industry, while profit maximization may be the ultimate goal, there are various metrics that a CEO monitors on a daily, monthly and quarterly basis. The objective of this course is for students to understand the metrics and be able to apply mathematical techniques to measure industries. This year, the course will include a new industry around non-profit organizations.

This CEO dashboard will differ from industry to industry. For example:

- In the insurance industry, monitored data will be net premiums written, distribution points, and loss ratios.
- In the retail industry, same-store sales, inventory levels, and new designs introduced are key metrics
- In the fund management industry, assets under management, fees and asset types

The class will delve into the specifics of each industry. What metrics do CEOs use to make decisions? How does one calculate these?

The goal of every lecture is to develop a framework for a CEO's dashboard and design the CEO's dashboard for different industries. Students will use mathematical techniques to design these dashboards. Classes will include interactive simulations and contests for students to apply these principles.

ENT-1016-1 - Jugaad and the Tech Enterprise - Jaideep Prabhu, Mukesh Sud, Priyank Narayan (2 credits)

In a world increasingly driven by technology and innovation, businesses often face challenges that require creative problem-solving and resource-efficient solutions. This course explores the intersection of frugal innovation (*jugaad*) and high-tech industries. The course will highlight how jugaad principles can be applied to develop scalable and sustainable solutions within high-tech enterprises, fostering a culture of ingenuity and adaptability. This undergraduate course explores the principles, strategies, and practices of frugal innovation/entrepreneurs in high technology sectors. Students will examine how resource-constrained environments can lead to creative and efficient solutions, focusing on technological advancements that deliver high value at a low cost. Students will also get opportunities to learn how to be frugal entrepreneurs in high-tech sectors by analyzing

examples of such enterprises. Through a combination of lectures, case studies, group projects, and discussions, students will develop a comprehensive understanding of the role of frugal innovation and entrepreneurship in driving technological progress and delivering societal impact. The conceptual framework of the course will be a roadmap or playbook with key principles that guide frugal innovation and entrepreneurship across high-tech sectors. Key strategies of how to get more and do better with less will include demand and supply-side approaches to overcoming resource constraints in developing and delivering highly affordable solutions at scale.

ENT 1019 - Digital Ecosystem of India (Previously *Data and the Digital Economy*)
- Arvind Gupta (2 credits)

This course is designed to immerse students in the evolving landscape of the digital economy, highlighting its impact on global consumer behaviour and the associated policy implications. Through six comprehensive sessions, each lasting 180 minutes, participants will explore how digital technologies are reshaping industries and influencing consumer patterns. The curriculum emphasizes a deep understanding of the Fourth Industrial Revolution and its effects on both business practices and economic strategies. A significant focus is placed on policy issues, including data governance and the balance between regulation and innovation. Students will engage in case studies, discussions, and practical activities to bridge theoretical knowledge with real-world applications. By examining diverse regulatory frameworks and the digital transformation in countries like India, students will gain insights into effective policy-making in a digital context. Designed for a broad student base, the course aims to provide foundational knowledge while encouraging students to apply concepts to their specific fields and interests. The structured sessions facilitate an in-depth exploration of each

topic, preparing students to navigate and contribute to the future industrial paradigms driven by digital advancements.

ENT-2002-1 - Social Entrepreneurship and Impact - Advaita Rajendra

This course aims to support students to create and build organizations that are ecologically sensitive and socially relevant. In the changing context of the urgent need to handle climate change, environmental degradation, and increasing social inequality, the course walks students through opportunities and challenges for organizations.

The course will draw on cases from a wide variety of settings varying from large organizations like Patagonia to smaller startups like Skrap and lessons from the margins -- newspaper vendors, street vendors, traditional arts and crafts -- lessons of management from the unexplored sector of the informal. Through critical readings, analysis of videos, and case discussions, participants will engage with the social and environmental challenges the society is facing.

During field visits, through deeper engagements with organizations and collectives that have been developing a path of environmentally and socially conscious journeys, participants will set foot on such paths, by developing the possibilities and potentials to create more of such paths, not only at a larger scale of building new organizations but also by incorporating and integrating versatile and pluralistic values and logics of environmentally and socially conscious decision making.

In-class discussions will be largely based on the cases and readings assigned to the sessions. This will create a space to learn ways in which collectives and organizations are being built and, further, shaping environmental and social consciousness. The course will involve field visits to socially conscious enterprises to give the students a first-hand experience of what social entrepreneurship looks like in reality.

ENT-2011-1- Business Analysis and Strategy - Akhil Dhawan, Pavan Ahluwalia and Sanjay Kukreja

What differentiates a good business from a mediocre one? How do you evaluate the quality of an industry and how can it change over time? Does a particular market entry plan, strategic plan or acquisition make sense? What tools do analysts, consultants, investors or industry professionals use to examine and gain insights into a business opportunity or problem?

The goal of this course is to provide students with tools and concepts that have real-world applicability in understanding and addressing business situations. The content is designed to bring frameworks and methods used in today's workplace into the classroom. Whether you choose to pursue a career in consulting, banking, investing, corporate strategy, or journalism, this course will provide you with a foundation that will allow you to analyze a business or an industry situation.

By the third session of this course, students will be assigned to teams of 4-6 members (depending on final class size) to begin work on their projects for a Business Crackathon (which serves as the final project for the class). The projects will address a specific business agenda from the real world, such as: (i) After completing the Just Dial transaction, should Reliance consider acquiring Nykaa or another listed company? or (ii) Shoppers Stop is evaluating a strategic reset in light of India going online and needs advice, or (iii) The Birla Group wants to restructure their portfolio for the next five years – what should stay and what should go?

Teams will choose a project topic from a list of topics (at the end of Session 3) and spend most of the semester working together on their final presentation, building on their work as instructors progress through concepts. The Business Crackathon will take place during the final session of the course, and teams will present to a panel of industry leaders. Our first

course featured a panel including Mr. Arindam Bhattacharya (a partner at BCG), Mr. Sanjeev Bikhchandani (co-founder of Info Edge), and Mr. Ashish Dhawan (CEO of Convergence Foundation). Specific guidelines on presentation structure, evaluation criteria as well as other rules for the Crackathon will be provided in class.

ENT-2012 - 1 - Real Estate and Investments - Yash Gupta (2 credits)

The course "Real Estate and Investments" offers an in-depth exploration of the various dimensions of the real estate sector and its interplay with the broader economy. This course introduces participants to key concepts such as Real Estate Investment, Property Development, Asset Management, and the impact of technology through PropTech. Students will delve into the lifecycle of real estate development, learning about site selection, market analysis, regulatory considerations, construction management, and sales strategies. A special focus will be placed on family businesses, which play a dominant role in the real estate industry, exploring their advantages, challenges, and professionalization.

The course also covers personal real estate portfolio optimization, teaching students how to make sound decisions when purchasing property, obtaining loans, and identifying lucrative investment opportunities. Participants will also examine the role of Affordable Housing in India's urban landscape, understanding government policies, investment strategies, and technological advancements in this sector. The final session will emphasize sustainability in real estate, exploring the importance of ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) factors, and the rise of Net Zero Buildings.

Through a blend of lectures, case study discussions, guest lectures from industry experts, and field visits, students will gain practical insights and a well-rounded understanding of the real estate market and its future trends.

ENT-2019/ PSY-3163-1- Branding and Consumer Behavior - Vani Dandia

This orientation course designed for those aspiring to build a successful career in branding and marketing. It serves as a gateway to understanding the foundational principles of marketing and brand-building, offering answers to critical questions such as: How are iconic brands created? What strategies propel them to the top, and what keeps them there? You'll also delve into the psychology of consumer behaviour, learning how savvy marketers craft compelling narratives and how leading marketers create strategies to strengthen their brands and drive business growth. This course will give you insights into the tactics that fuel brand longevity and market leadership.

ENT-2022-1- Life Design Lab - Navyug Mohnot (2 Credits)

The Designing Your Life (DYL) course is inspired by the bestselling course (being offered for over 15 years) and extensive research at Stanford University and Stanford's Life Design Lab (200 higher ed institutions have engaged with Stanford's Life Design lab); is based on the bestselling book of the same name, by Stanford Professors Bill Burnett and Dave Evans. The course is offered under a license through Certified Instructor and Coach, Navyug Mohnot. DYL is a philosophy, framework and process with a set of tried and tested tools and methods based on principles of Design Thinking. The course aims to enable people to figure out where they are now, get 'unstuck' and plan what they could do next with their lives.

ENT-2027 - 1 - Impact Investing, ESG and Climate - Kartik Desai

This course is designed to help students develop a foundational understanding of the key principles, frameworks, tools and examples of impact investing, and innovative finance (blended/outcomes finance), their evolution and application in India in funding for social and

climate impact. It covers theory and practice, focusing on case studies of the most relevant funding institutions that have pioneered the major asset classes across the innovative finance spectrum. It provides a solid primer on social capital markets and how to set up and run a social investment fund vehicle, as well as background on the key policy and regulatory issues shaping this space from an integrated perspective across equity, debt, grants and recent developments such as the social stock exchange.

The course is designed for students with an interest and background in development economics, social entrepreneurship, capital markets and venture capital who want to apply their understanding of economics, finance and investing to create positive social and environmental impact through new business models and financing structures. It will provide a comprehensive overview of the innovative finance landscape and its context through an analytical assessment of each segment on the capital spectrum, and an evaluation of case studies of major impact investors and their use of different innovative finance instruments to help solve major development challenges in climate change, social inclusion and income creation.

The course will place equal emphasis on Impact Investment and Blended/Outcomes Finance. We will look at two types of Equity Investment (finance-first and impact-first) as well as Debt Investment, and evaluate the different types of Blended/Outcomes. Financing structures, before looking at cross-cutting topics like Climate Finance and Gender Lens Investing, and examining how Impact Investment & Innovative Finance compare with Public Finance, Venture Philanthropy, ESG and SRI, concluding with a Policy Roadmap for the overall sector.

The main objective of the course is to help students ‘think like an impact funder’ by understanding critical insights and lessons from the experience of pioneering funds who 1 Foundation of Impact Investing & Innovative Finance (Kartikeya N. Desai) have helped

define innovative finance in India and intelligently frame the practical debates facing these funds to enable the students to pursue further research and build careers in this field.

ENT-2028-1- Integrated Digital Marketing - Shradha Agarwal (2 credits)

Integrated digital marketing strategy in 2023 is about how to pull, sell and manage loyalty across consumer cohorts. Today consumers love authentic brands but they still believe in a fling than a marriage. How do we reach out to this consumer in this cluttered space? How do we keep this consumer engaged with us? What do we do to keep them coming back to us?

The complete digital marketing strategy today for any brand lies in 3 simple Cs, now whether you are a budding entrepreneur, a digital manager for a brand or working in a digital agency.

- Content: To reach, engage and drive experiences
- Commerce: To pull (and not push) them down the funnel
- Community: To keep them engaged and coming back

ENT-2032/ POL-2120-1 -Technology Law and Policy: A New Frontier for Business and Society Overview - Nikhil Sud

Myth: “This course is heavy on tech. Expertise/interest in tech is necessary.”

Reality: Not at all. Tech is just the context. The course is about policy issues on the internet platforms we all use constantly – issues that affect us all, such as privacy; censorship; competition and choice; and others.

This course will draw from the first-hand experience of a seasoned global tech lawyer and policy practitioner to explore emerging law and policy issues in the context of technology – in India and key foreign contexts including the U.S. and Europe. Given the increasingly pervasive nature of technology, these issues bring new and critical implications for a wide variety of professionals and businesses including but not only startups and other

entrepreneurial initiatives; for society at large; and for the roles that businesses can play in society. These issues also transcend national boundaries and routinely reflect and influence complex interactions between different nations.

The course will address issues including data privacy; free speech and content moderation; competition; and others – and also distill practical skills and insights that cut across the various substantive issues discussed in the course. In doing so, the course will help prepare students to understand, navigate, and shape tech law and policy as part of the business world and more broadly – in India and globally – drawing from the instructor’s first-hand leadership experience in crafting and executing innovative, high-impact strategies in the field.

ENT-2034-1 - Demystifying Investments: Private Equity and Venture Capital - Sridhar Sethuram

The rapid expansion of institutional capital in emerging markets, including India, has opened up vast opportunities for entrepreneurs across multiple sectors, including the social impact space. Institutional capital encompasses various funding sources, such as grants, angel investments, seed funding, venture capital, private equity, and long-term hedge funds. This course provides students with a chance to explore the opportunities and challenges that institutional investors face, featuring India-specific case studies and insights from successful investors and entrepreneurs. It covers a range of industries, including real estate, fintech, social enterprises, and e-commerce. The course is built on the core belief that every individual, regardless of their profession, must think like an entrepreneur and investor. Whether you are salaried or self-employed, entrepreneurial thinking is essential. The same investment principles apply to career decisions, particularly when considering how to invest your time—the most valuable capital. Students will learn how their post-graduation career journey reflects the life cycle of an enterprise, from the risk-seeking stage of a startup,

through venture capital and private equity phases, to a more conservative, listed company stage, where performance and adaptability are crucial to survival. Though focused on unlisted investments, the course's primary goal is to develop the ability to: a) recognize and confront areas where we lack knowledge, b) identify the issues critical to your success, and c) establish a mental framework for continuous learning and understanding. Students will also encounter the paralyzing effects of fear of failure and the feeling of helplessness that can impede success—not just in investments but in life decisions, including the choice to commit time and effort to this course.

ENT-2039 -1 - Law and Lawyerly Thinking: An Introduction for Entrepreneurs and Beyond - Nikhil Sud

So you don't want to be a lawyer. Or maybe you do. Who knows, and who cares, because either way, a general understanding of key legal concepts – and the ability to think like a lawyer – will add invaluable to your arsenal as you step out into the real world. This knowledge and skillset will make you a distinctly sharper leader in the business world, because legal issues routinely – and increasingly – strike at the heart of business risks and opportunities, and are integral to overall corporate strategy. And so not just lawyers but a wide range of business executives (including C-suite executives) and their advisors routinely work on legal issues alongside lawyers. Legal roles are increasingly business roles, and vice versa. Therefore, the knowledge and skills this course provides will make you a sharper entrepreneur, or a sharper business executive, or a sharper consultant to businesses across sectors. But that's not all. The benefits extend to countless roles even beyond the business world: you'll be a sharper problem-solver regardless of field. To this end, the course will explore key concepts across several fundamental areas of law including contracts, torts, constitutional, criminal, administrative, competition, and procedural – each of which is

applicable across a wide range of professional fields. The course will explore these concepts in two jurisdictions: India and the U.S. The course will also introduce students to thinking (and related) skills fundamental to not just the legal profession but also to the many professional roles (discussed above) that require frequent engagement with the law or with lawyers. These skills include: contract construction and interpretation; analyzing and applying a case; textual interpretation more broadly; analytical writing; persuasive writing; persuasive verbal argument; and highly analytical thinking with unrelenting precision, agility, and creativity.

ENT-2040 -1 - Strategies for Revenue Leadership - Gaurav Rastogi (2 credits)

This 18-hour curriculum is designed for the next generation of leaders. We will address the pain-points of entrepreneurs, CEOs, Chief Growth Managers, Product Managers, and Chief Commercial Officers who seek to master the art and science of growing and sustaining revenue growth in the Enterprise B2B ecosystem.

Participants will gain an understanding of go-to-market strategies, product-market messaging, solution selling, deal closure, and sales performance management for scale. The course combines theory, real-world case studies, interactive activities, and expert insights to equip students with the knowledge and skills necessary to drive revenue growth and lead successful organizations.

ENT-2042-1 - Technology and Product Management - Nikhil Sud

Product management is one of the most sought-after functions in today's organizations, whether in technology product firms or elsewhere. Technology firms differentiate from their competitors based on how user-centred their products are, and non-tech firms such as banks

similarly aim to stay competitive by implementing product-based thinking in their technology offerings.

Digital product managers who can drive product vision and business growth have hence become critical to modern firms. Initially, a Silicon Valley phenomenon, the growing importance of product management – a cross-functional discipline which comprises a deep focus on customers and design, emphasizes the centrality of data in making decisions and the importance of keeping abreast of evolving technological and market dynamics, and utilizes business metrics to evaluate the success of technological innovations – now means that product managers can be found in firms across sectors and industries. The product function is hence a critical differentiator that determines whether a technology product satisfies user needs in a seamless way, ensuring rapid adoption by customers, or becomes a hindrance towards achieving business goals.

This product management course will teach important skills necessary to be an effective product manager and build, launch, and grow successful digital products. Key focus areas include assessing customer pain points, designing a compelling product vision, leveraging product analytics, and working effectively across functions, including engineering, UX and senior management. Students will engage in group exercises and case discussions.

ENT-2044 -1 - Fundamentals of Quantitative Problem Solving using Excel - (Previously *Problem Solving Using Microsoft Excel*) -Ashish Mathur (2 credits)

Microsoft Excel is the most widely used spreadsheet software and is used by people across industries & organizations irrespective of their type and level. In today's world where data is the new oil, data from multiple data sources ultimately lands up in an MS Excel file. The

challenge of the professionals of tomorrow will be the ease with which they can solve business problems/questions that come their way.

Welcome to the comprehensive course – ‘ENT-2044 Fundamentals of Quantitative Problem Solving using Excel’. In today's digitally driven world, proficiency in Excel is an indispensable asset, whether you're a student, a professional, an entrepreneur, or someone eager to enhance their data management capabilities. This course is designed to equip you with the knowledge and practical expertise required to navigate Excel with confidence, efficiency, and finesse.

Microsoft Excel stands tall as one of the most powerful and versatile spreadsheet applications available, and its impact spans across various industries and domains. From finance to marketing, from engineering to data analysis, Excel empowers users to organize, analyze, and visualize data in ways that drive informed decision-making. Regardless of your background or profession, Excel proficiency is a gateway to unlocking numerous opportunities and streamlining your daily tasks. It allows you to handle large datasets, automate repetitive tasks, create visually compelling charts and graphs, perform complex calculations, and more. Whether you're managing personal finances, conducting business analyses, or preparing academic reports, Excel is the go-to tool for data analysis and presentation.

ENT-2045 -1 Business Application of Data Science (Previously: Artificial Intelligence and Data Analytics) - Tushar Jaruhar

The "Business Applications of Data Science" course offers a comprehensive exploration of the core concepts and tools necessary for leveraging AI and data analytics in decision-making. Designed for students aspiring to work in the fields of data science, AI, and business analytics, this course combines theoretical knowledge with hands-on practice across multiple key areas. The future of work is expected to evolve rapidly. Artificial intelligence

(AI) is going to drive this change. We are already feeling the impact of AI in several products and services that we use almost daily. For example, Google uses an AI tool to selectively show us advertisements. The income tax department is using A.I. with business intelligence to identify people who have not been paying taxes. The world of medicine is undergoing changes with A.I. being used to identify cancerous cells.

Companies are looking to hire data analysts and scientists who can create novel products and solve complex problems. The acute shortage of skilled manpower is being felt globally. Therefore, providing undergraduate students with skills in artificial intelligence and business insights is the need of the hour.

This course is designed to teach students the core concepts of data analytics. It is oriented towards undergraduates who may not necessarily have coding skills. The audience is expected to have the willingness to learn and explore. The focus will be to help students create a portfolio of projects where they can demonstrate the application of data analytics. By the end of this course, students will be proficient in using AI and data analytics tools to solve real-world problems, making them well-equipped for roles in data science and AI-driven decision-making.

ENT-3007-1- Fundamentals of Investing - Rahul Bhasin, Deepali Singh

"Do you have questions like: Should I invest in bonds, stocks, real estate, mutual funds, or gold? Should I invest in a company that is fundamentally strong, or one that is currently very cheap in the market? How do I judge whether the current share price I see on the Zerodha screen reflects the true value? The market companions are trading at a very high P/E ratio compared to this stock—does that make it a good investment? Which technological innovations will yield extraordinary returns? What characteristics make a company adaptable to change? As a student without access to management, how can I analyze a company? What

should I look for in an annual report? How should I think about an industry? What checklist should be followed before making an investment? People say this company will grow by 20%—how did they arrive at that number? Can management turnarounds happen? What are the different profit models, and how do you identify them? How did investors like Warren Buffett make money? What did they see that others did not? What is the concept of a 'moat'? What's the difference between the value and price of a share? Which stock should I buy?.....

You'll find answers to all these questions and many more in the course. The Fundamentals of Investing course offers a thorough exploration of investment principles, designed to prepare students for both personal and professional investment management. Spanning 26 sessions and worth 4 credits, the course is structured into four comprehensive modules that cover a wide range of investment topics and strategies. The course content begins with an introduction to various investment options, including deposits, debt, equity, private equity, real estate, mutual funds, and commodities. Students will learn to evaluate the relevance and potential payoffs associated with different asset classes while understanding the psychological factors that influence investment decisions. Key financial concepts such as the time value of money and discounted cash flows are introduced early on, providing a solid foundation for further study. Additionally, students engage in practical exercises, including asset allocation strategies and stock-picking frameworks, enhancing their analytical skills in real-world contexts.

The students will go through an intensive checklist and learn different tests to evaluate stocks. These include, but are not limited to, the macro test, value test, growth test, profitability test, timing and transaction strategy, and over 25 other considerations in the market. Students will not only learn various parameters and how to apply different tests to

stocks, but they will also build assumptions and learn how to forecast the parameters in these tests.

This course is applicable in numerous settings, from personal finance management to corporate investment strategies. Students will develop critical skills such as risk assessment, valuation techniques, and behavioral finance insights. These skills are essential for making informed investment decisions and understanding market dynamics. Furthermore, the course emphasizes the importance of macroeconomic factors and government policies on investment returns, equipping students with a holistic view of the investing landscape.

Industry relevance is a core aspect of this course. Taught by experienced professionals like Rahul Bhasin, Managing Partner at Baring Private Equity Partners India, and Deepali Singh, an expert in corporate finance and investment banking, students benefit from insights drawn from real-world experiences in private equity and financial markets. The faculty's extensive backgrounds ensure that students are exposed to current industry practices and challenges.

Throughout the course, participants will delve into advanced topics such as venture capital dynamics, leveraged buyouts, and the implications of technological innovations on market structures. They will also explore environmental sustainability issues related to investments, preparing them for contemporary challenges faced by investors today.

The course will conclude with a stock presentation on international stocks, where students will need to understand the fundamentals of every aspect of a new country, market, and its people. This exercise helps them grasp how small factors can have a significant impact and learn to think from scratch, setting aside any biases.

ENT-3011-1- Strategies for Market Access - Shantanu Bhanja

For individuals in roles such as start-up founders, product managers, marketing managers, or sales heads, this comprehensive course offers valuable real-world knowledge and practical

tools to succeed in building and growing a business. Gain a strong foundation and practical understanding of market landscape analysis, value proposition development, stakeholder dynamics, competitive strategies, and the buying process. Explore different business models, effective Go-to-Market strategies, and success models for e-commerce and modern trade. Hands-on exercises include building pricing models and navigating real-world business situations. Other topics covered include key performance indicators (KPIs) for success, influencer marketing, and customer lifetime value. This course empowers you with the skills needed to thrive in the business world, regardless of your industry or organization type.

ENT-3014/PSY-3164-1- Branding and Consumer Behavior (Advanced) - Vani

Dandia

How are iconic brands built? What gets them there and how they stay there? How smart marketers influence consumer behaviour to make their brands even stronger. And get more business.

LEVEL 1: was an introduction to the building blocks of a brand. We covered what is the value of a strong brand, how brands are different from commodities, what is good advertising, how does one uncover consumer insights, basic principles in consumer behaviour, and why every brand today must think like a challenger.

LEVEL 2: will focus on learning how to launch a strong brand, build a business with multiple product lines and how does one accelerate business by addressing growth challenges through the full marketing funnel.

This course offers an in-depth exploration into the dynamic world of marketing, providing a unique opportunity to connect with top industry professionals in marketing, advertising, and media. Throughout the course, you will learn how to launch and establish a powerful brand,

develop a business with a diverse range of product lines, and tackle key growth challenges. The course also focuses on strategies to accelerate business success by leveraging every stage of the marketing funnel, ensuring you gain the tools needed to drive impactful growth. The course will also introduce you to behavioural dimensions of marketing, the process of consumer decision-making, the nitty-gritty of market segmentation and brand positioning, the manner in which a consumer learns about a brand/company/product and forms their perception of the same; and more importantly – how these theoretical insights can be put to use in practical marketing concepts by a marketer.

ENT-3016 - 1- Financial Analytics using Artificial Intelligence - Tushar Jaruhar

The growing computing power and abundance of data have revolutionized the finance industry. Algorithmic trading utilizes trading data to make stock buying and selling decisions, while the income tax department analyzes taxpayer data to identify tax evasion. Similarly, determining credit card eligibility for individuals with low to medium savings is another application. Mastering technology, mathematical algorithms, and finance knowledge opens doors to various opportunities, including working for large companies, starting a startup, trading in markets, research, and financial consulting. This course introduces market understanding, data analysis, and algorithm application for decision-making in finance, covering topics like stock price prediction, fraud detection, credit assessment, option pricing, and financial attribute analysis. The course aims to equip undergraduates with these skills, allowing them to pursue challenging finance careers globally, regardless of coding proficiency. The focus is on creating a project portfolio to showcase the practical application of data analytics.

ENT-4012-1- Venture Design Lab (Previously *Startup Incubation Lab*) - Srikant

Sastri

Entrepreneurship and Intrapreneurship are now part of mainstream business learning. While the booming startup ecosystem in India reflects the surge in entrepreneurship, bigger companies in the corporate sector are also embracing innovation and intrapreneurship to stay relevant and succeed in a fast-changing world. However, innovation needs to be rooted in customer-centricity. As seen in recent years, many promising startups have gone astray because of excessive valuation focus, or because founders are fixated on technology rather than customers & revenues.

This hands-on boot camp course aims to intertwine theory & practice so that students learn key concepts of new ventures and implement them with firmly customer-centric actions. This course also aims to prepare students with the right balance of hard and soft skills. On the one hand, students – who so desire- would be well equipped to pursue their startup dreams. On the other hand, students who want to work in the corporate sector will have the confidence to be successful intrapreneurs driving innovation in these larger companies.

In this course, students will experience the full journey from an Idea to an MVP (Minimum Viable Product) all the while keeping a sharp focus on customer centricity.

In each class session, a ‘hard’ or ‘soft’ startup concept (“theory”) will be introduced in the class. Students will then (working in groups) execute that concept (“practical”) in the weeks to come. This will be done, class after class, as students get exposed to a series of concepts that are important for the development of an early-stage customer-centric venture. Students will also do individual reflection during the first few weeks, and then at some periodicity.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q: Can 1st yr students directly start 2000 and 3000 level courses for the Spring 25 semester?

A: Yes, first years can start with 2000 or 3000-level courses as there are no prerequisites. However, it is recommended to decide based on particular course difficulty.

Q: How many courses do I need to complete a minor/concentration in Entrepreneurial Leadership and Strategy?

A: Like all other minors, you need 24 credits to finish a minor in Entrepreneurship. You need 16 credits to finish a concentration.

Q: Can I finish my Entrepreneurship minor within 3 years?

A: It is possible to finish the minor within three years. However, it is important to plan your courses in advance.

Note: there is no level-wise sequence of courses that you have to follow in Entrepreneurship. However, it is recommended that students take the basic courses first before jumping on the advanced courses. Please reach out to the representatives who can help you out with a sample trajectory which will be discussed on a case-by-case basis.

Q: What are the mandatory requirements to finish my Entrepreneurship minor/concentration?

A: The only mandatory Entrepreneurship requirement is that you take 24 credits for a minor and 16 credits for a concentration.

Q: Can I take a 300-level course before a 100-level course?

A: Yes, you can.

Q: Do I need to take 2000-level courses before taking 3000-level courses?

A: No.

Q: How can I earn extra credits for Entrepreneurship?

A: Apart from taking courses, these are the ways to get credits:

- TAsip
- ISM (Independent Study Module),
- Venture Immersion Program
- Study Abroad.

Q: Who should I contact for further queries?

A: You can email your queries to the Student Representatives:

Hubaba Masood (hubaba.masood_ug25@ashoka.edu.in)

Tarini Kochar (tarini.kochar_asp25@ashoka.edu.in)

Siddharth Chandak (siddharth.chadnak_ug25@ashoka.edu.in)

OR The Department (entrepreneurship@ashoka.edu.in)